

Publishing and Sharing in Tableau

Question:1 What is the key difference between publishing a dashboard on Tableau Public versus Tableau Server/Cloud in terms of accessibility and data security?

Answer:

The main difference between Tableau Public and Tableau Server/Cloud is **accessibility and data security.**

Tableau Public:

- Tableau Public is a free platform where dashboards are published publicly on the internet.
- Anyone with the dashboard link can view and access the dashboard.
- Data security is very limited because all published work is publicly available.
- It is mainly used for practice, portfolios, and public data visualization.
- Sensitive or confidential business data should never be published on Tableau Public.

Tableau Server/Cloud:

- Tableau Server and Tableau Cloud are secure platforms designed for organizations and businesses.
- Access is controlled through user accounts, permissions, and authentication.
- Only authorized users can view, edit, or interact with dashboards.
- It supports role-based security and data protection.
- These platforms are suitable for business reports containing private or confidential data.

Conclusion:

Tableau Public is best for openly shared dashboards, while Tableau Server/Cloud is best for secure business reporting with controlled access.

Question:2 When publishing a Tableau dashboard, what happens to a live connection compared to an extract? How does this affect data refresh and performance?

Answer:

When publishing a Tableau dashboard, the behavior of a live connection and an extract is different.

Live Connection:

- A live connection directly connects Tableau to the original database.
- Every time users open or interact with the dashboard, Tableau fetches real-time data from the database.
- Data is always up to date.
- Performance may become slower if the database is large or internet speed is low.
- It depends heavily on database availability and network connection.

Extract Connection:

- An extract stores a snapshot of the data inside Tableau.
- Tableau uses the stored data instead of connecting to the database every time.
- Dashboard performance becomes faster because data is already cached.
- Data is not updated automatically in real time.
- Refresh schedules must be created to update the extract regularly.

Effect on Refresh and Performance:

Feature	Live Connection	Extract
Data Update	Real-Time	Requires Refresh
Speed	Slower	Faster
Database Dependency	High	Low
Best For	Real-Time Monitoring	Faster Dashboard Performance

Conclusion:

Live connections provide updated data, while extracts improve dashboard speed and performance.

Question:3 In Tableau Server or Cloud (conceptually), which feature allows administrators to control which users can view, interact with, or edit a published dashboard?

Answer:

The feature used to control user access in Tableau Server or Tableau Cloud is called:

Permissions and User Roles

Explanation:

- Administrators use permissions to decide what actions users can perform.
- Different user roles can be assigned, such as Viewer, Explorer, and Creator.
- Permissions control whether users can:
 - View dashboards
 - Interact with filters
 - Download data
 - Edit workbooks
 - Publish dashboards

Examples:

- A Viewer can only see dashboards.
- An Explorer can interact and sometimes edit.
- A Creator can create and publish dashboards.

Conclusion:

Permissions and user roles help administrators securely manage access to Tableau dashboards.

Question:4 If you want users to view a dashboard but not download the underlying data, which permission setting would you adjust in Tableau Server?

Answer:

To prevent users from downloading underlying data while still allowing them to view the dashboard, the administrator should adjust the:

“Download Data” Permission

Explanation:

- In Tableau Server or Cloud, permissions can restrict data downloads.
- The administrator should disable:
 - Download Full Data
 - Download Summary Data
 - Download Workbook

Result:

- Users will still be able to view and interact with the dashboard.
- However, they will not be able to export or download the underlying dataset.

Conclusion:

The “Download Data” permission should be restricted to protect sensitive business information.

Question:5 Name two methods by which a Tableau dashboard can be embedded into a web page or website.

Answer:

Two common methods to embed a Tableau dashboard into a website are:

1. Embed Code (HTML iframe)

- Tableau provides embed code after publishing a dashboard.
- The iframe code can be copied and pasted into a website’s HTML.
- This method is simple and widely used.

2. Tableau JavaScript API

- Developers can use Tableau’s JavaScript API for advanced integration.
- It allows interactive control of dashboards using JavaScript.
- Filters, parameters, and events can be customized.

Conclusion:

Dashboards can be embedded using iframe embed code or the Tableau JavaScript API depending on the required level of customization.

Question:6 List two best practices you should follow when preparing a dashboard for public sharing to ensure data security and privacy.

Answer:

Two important best practices for secure public sharing are:

1. Remove Sensitive Information

- Never include confidential data such as:
 - Personal details
 - Passwords
 - Phone numbers

- Financial records
- Internal company data
- Use anonymized or aggregated data whenever possible.

2. Apply Proper Permissions and Security

- Use user authentication and permissions.
- Restrict download access if needed.
- Share dashboards only with authorized users.

Additional Good Practices:

- Verify data sources before publishing.
- Test dashboard security settings.
- Use extracts instead of direct database exposure when appropriate.

Conclusion:

Protecting sensitive data and applying correct permissions are essential for secure dashboard sharing.

Question:7 After publishing a dashboard, users report a “Data not found” error. What is the most common cause related to data source settings?

Answer:

The most common cause of a “Data not found” error is:

Broken or Incorrect Data Source Connection

Explanation:

This usually happens when:

- The database path has changed.
- The file location is missing.
- Database credentials are incorrect.
- The published workbook cannot access the original data source.
- Network or server connectivity issues exist.

Example:

If a dashboard uses an Excel file stored on a local computer, Tableau Server may not be able to access that file after publishing.

Solution:

- Reconnect the data source.
- Update database credentials.
- Use published data sources.
- Ensure the server has access to the required files or databases.

Conclusion:

Incorrect or broken data source settings are the most common reason for “Data not found” errors.

Question:8 When embedding a Tableau dashboard into a secure internal portal, what two additional security measures should be implemented to ensure only authorized users can access the embedded content?

Answer:

Two important security measures are:

1. User Authentication

- Require users to log in before accessing the dashboard.
- Use Single Sign-On (SSO), Active Directory, or secure login systems.
- This ensures only verified users can access the dashboard.

2. Row-Level Security and Permissions

- Apply role-based permissions and row-level security.
- Different users should only see the data relevant to them.
- Restrict access based on departments, teams, or job roles.

Additional Measures:

- Use HTTPS encryption.
- Disable unauthorized downloads.
- Monitor user activity and access logs.

Conclusion:

Authentication and permission-based security are essential for safely embedding Tableau dashboards in internal portals.